

Performance testing Kubernetes-Workloads

**CLOUD
NATIVE
FESTIVAL**
im Heide Park Soltau

**STEPHAN
SCHWARZ**

Senior DevOps Consultant
iits-consulting GmbH



20.05.2026
17:00 Uhr

about me

Stephan Schwarz

44 Jahre alt - verheiratet, zwei Kinder

Rollen in der Vergangenheit:

- Network Administrator
- Systems Engineer
- Cloud Engineer
- Infrastructure Developer
- Platform Engineer

seit 2017: **Kubernetes**

seit 2021: **Consultant**



what about you?



Es war einmal vor langer Zeit in einer
weit, weit entfernten Galaxis...



Was ist Performance?

Performance = **Erwartungen** werden **erfüllt** an:

- Durchsatz
- Latenz
- Skalierbarkeit
- Ressourcenverbrauch
- Verfügbarkeit

Erwartungen sind **individuell** unterschiedlich



Warum Lasttests?

- **Stabiler Betrieb**
- Testen der **Skalierbarkeit**
- Sicherstellung von **SLAs**
- Ermittlung der benötigten **Ressourcen**
- Optimierung von **Kosten**
- Aufdecken von **Bottlenecks**



Typische Bottlenecks



Requests / Limits

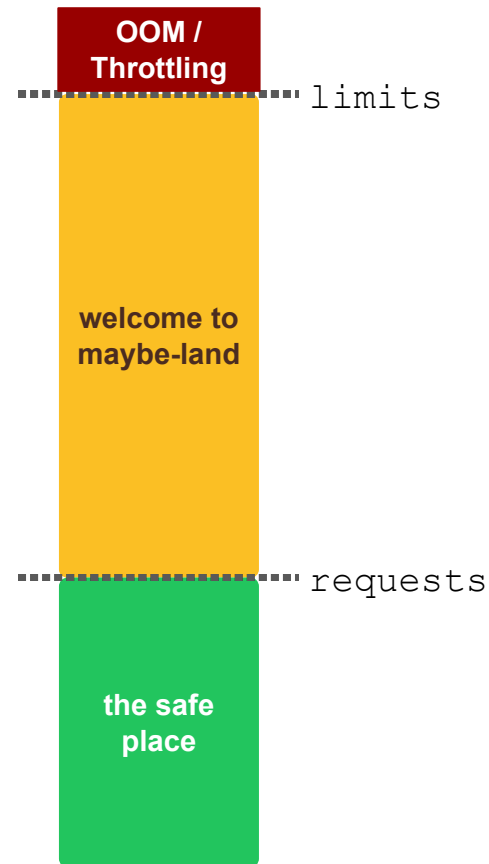
CPU / RAM

Typische Bottlenecks



Requests / Limits

CPU / RAM



Typische Bottlenecks



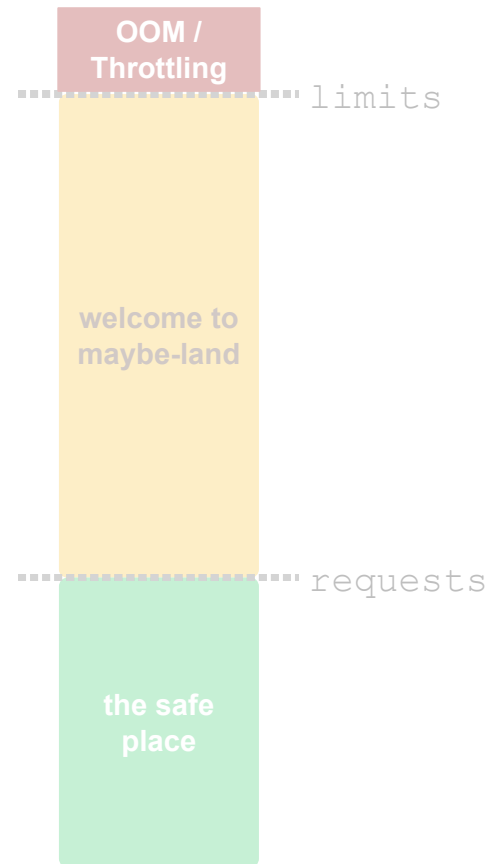
Requests / Limits

CPU / RAM



Disk I/O & Filehandles

IOPS, max. number of file handles and threads



Typische Bottlenecks



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CPU / RAM



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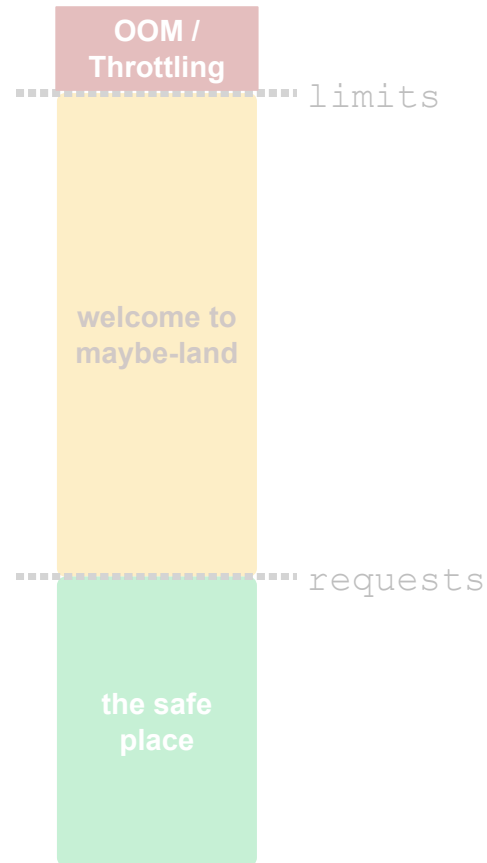


Netzwerk

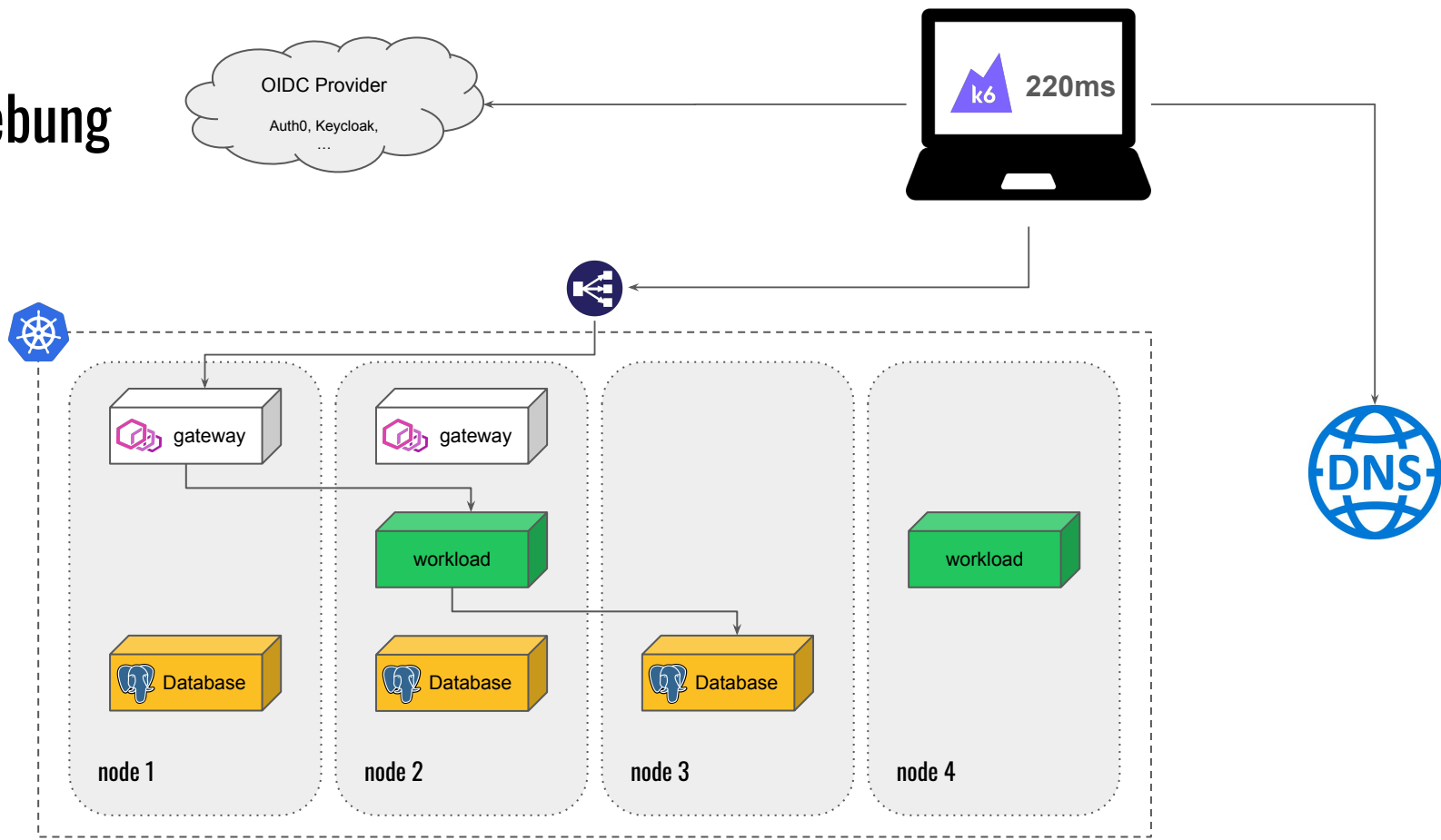
DNS, Ingress Controller, Service Mesh



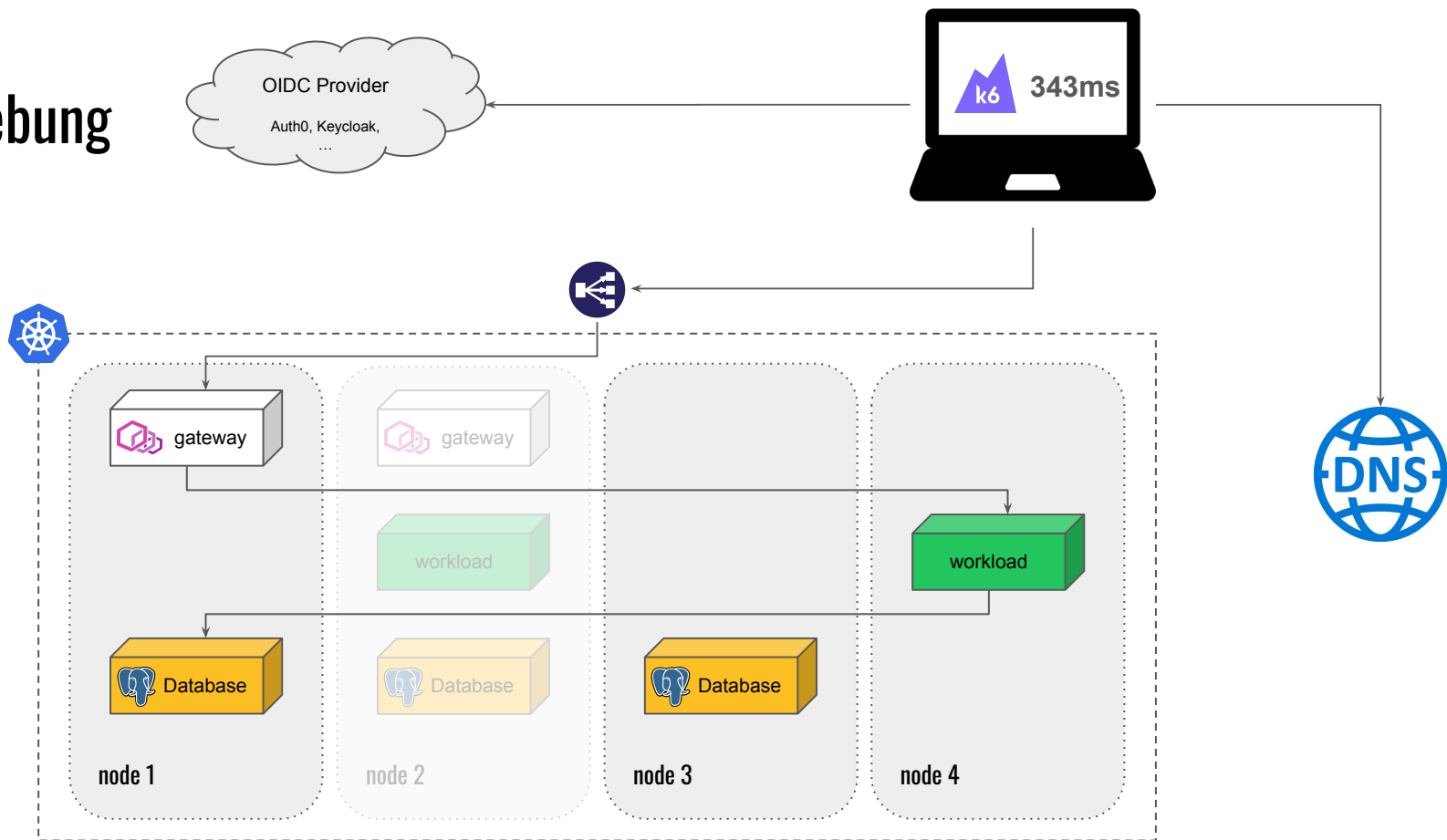
Externe Abhängigkeiten (DB, S3, APIs, ...)



Testumgebung

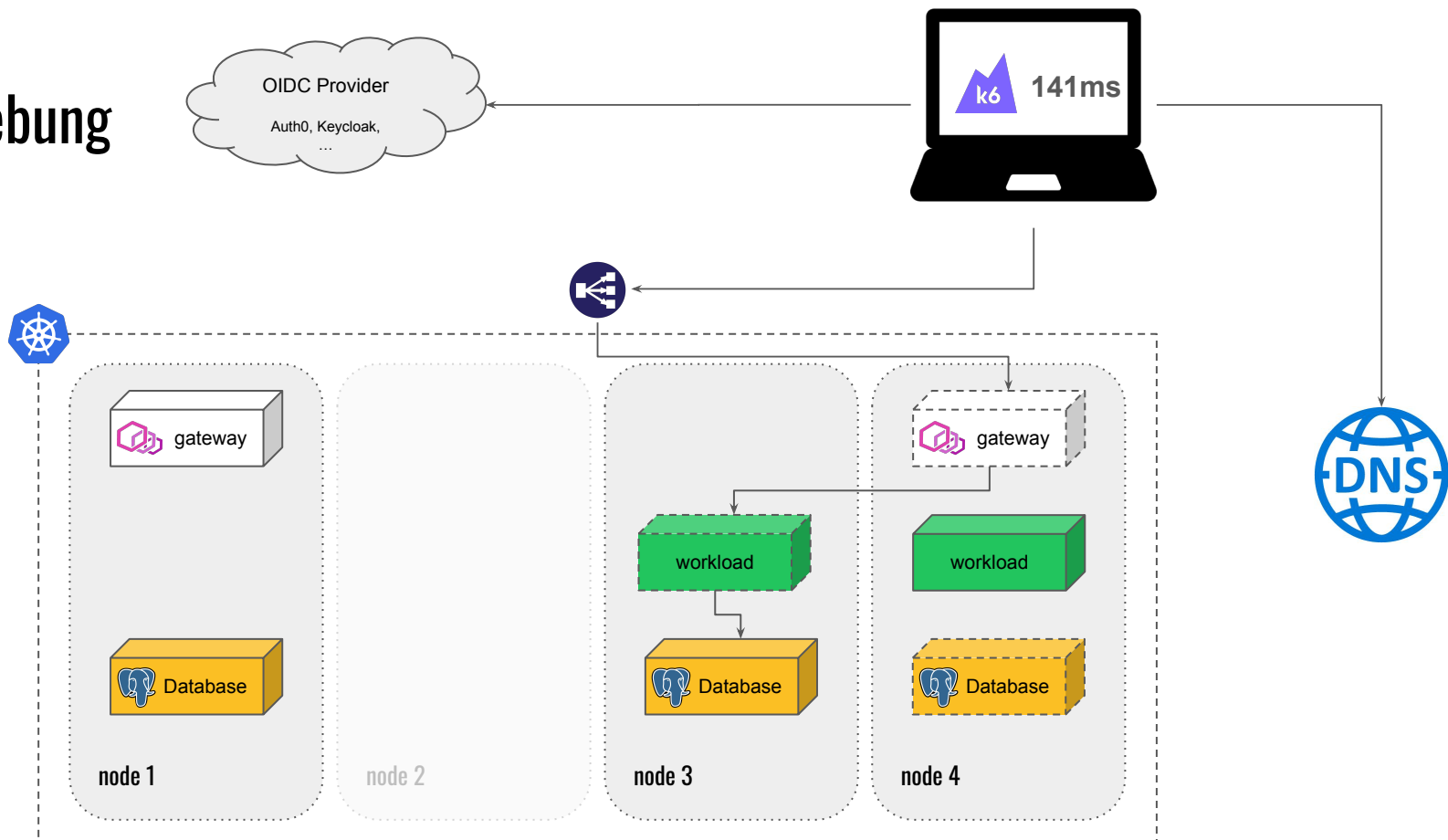


Testumgebung



Node failure

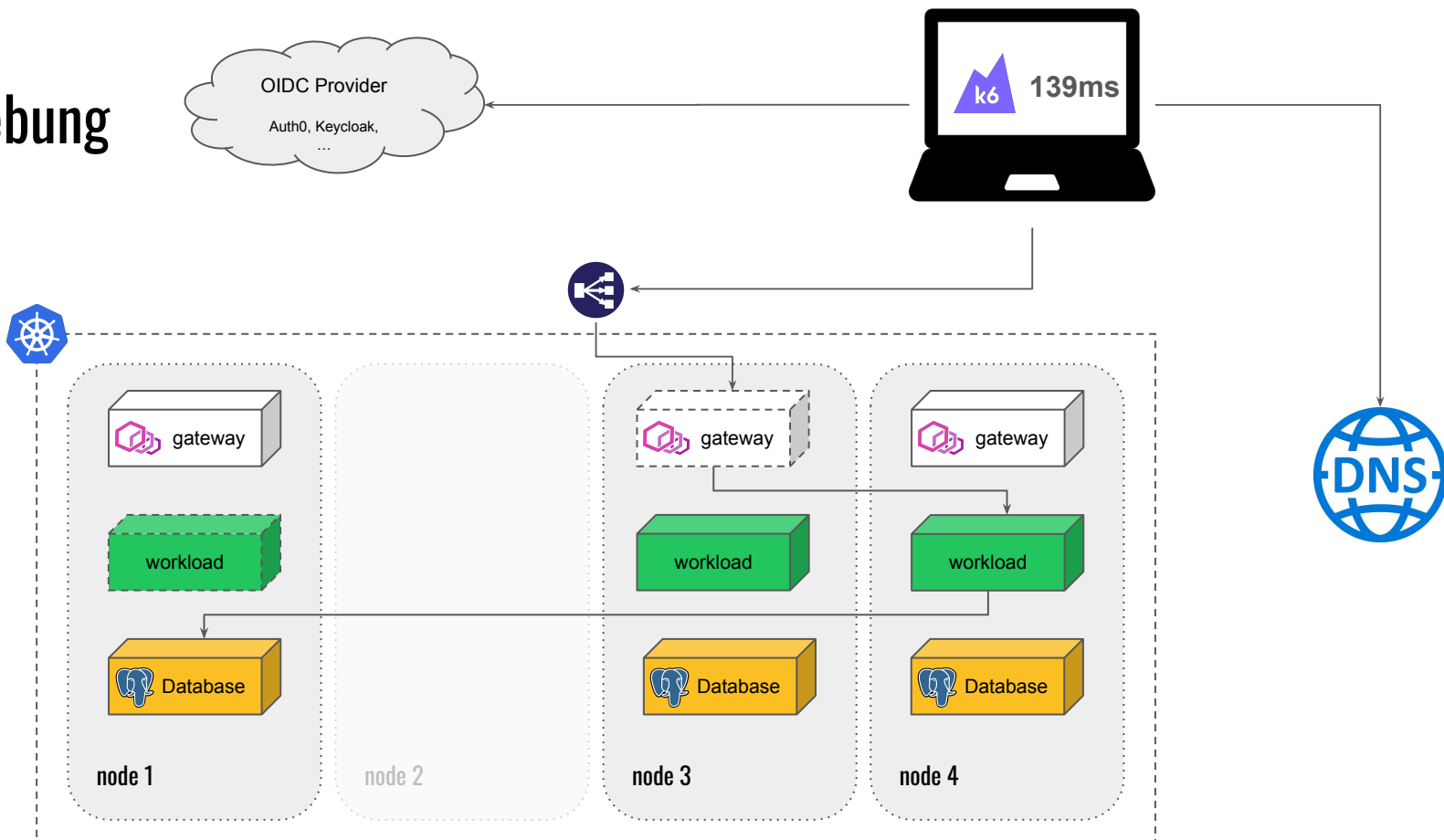
Testumgebung



Re-scheduling



Testumgebung



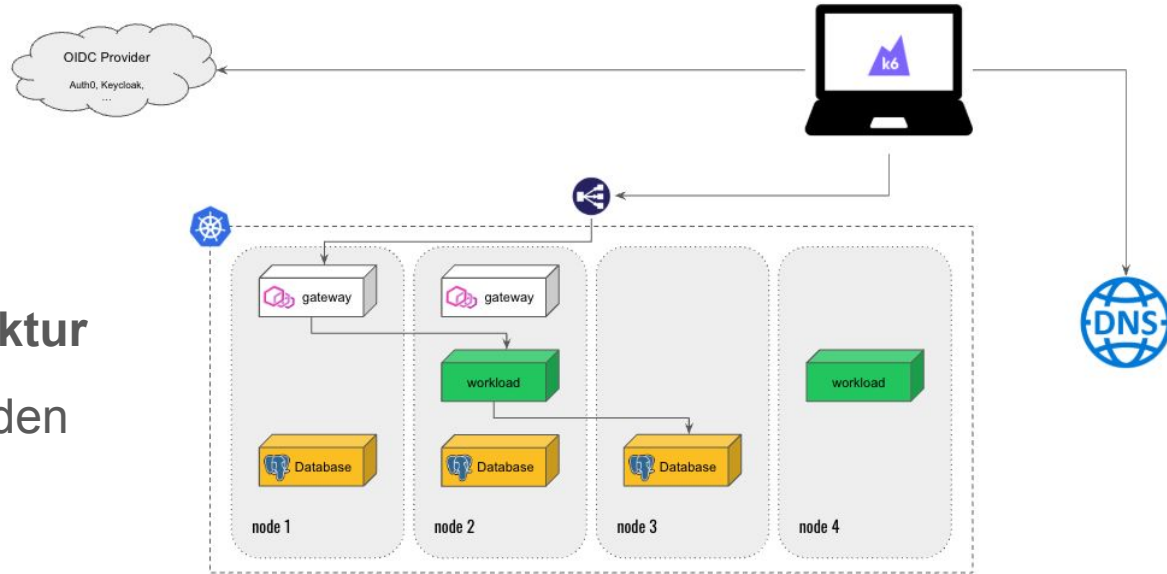
Horizontal pod autoscaling



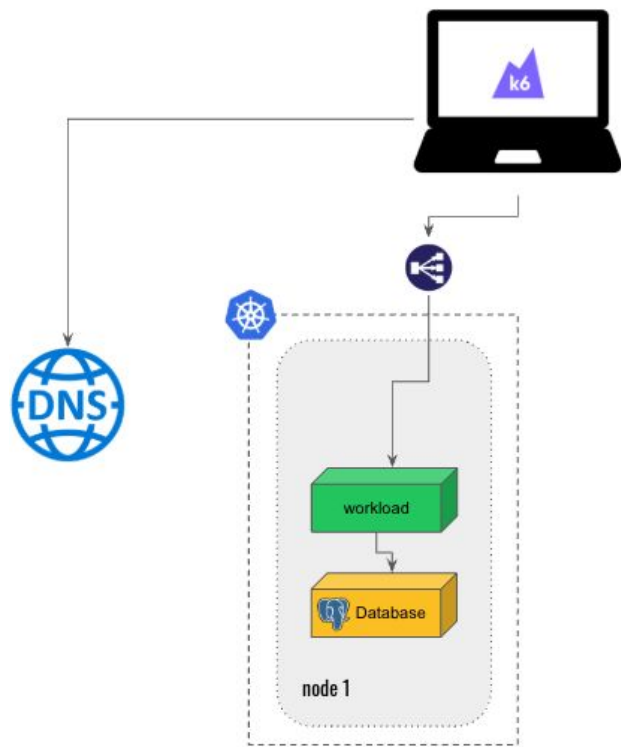
Testumgebung

End-to-end

- **Realitätsnah**
- **Kundenperspektive**
- Testet komplette **Infrastruktur**
- **Abhängige Services** werden mitgetestet



Testumgebung

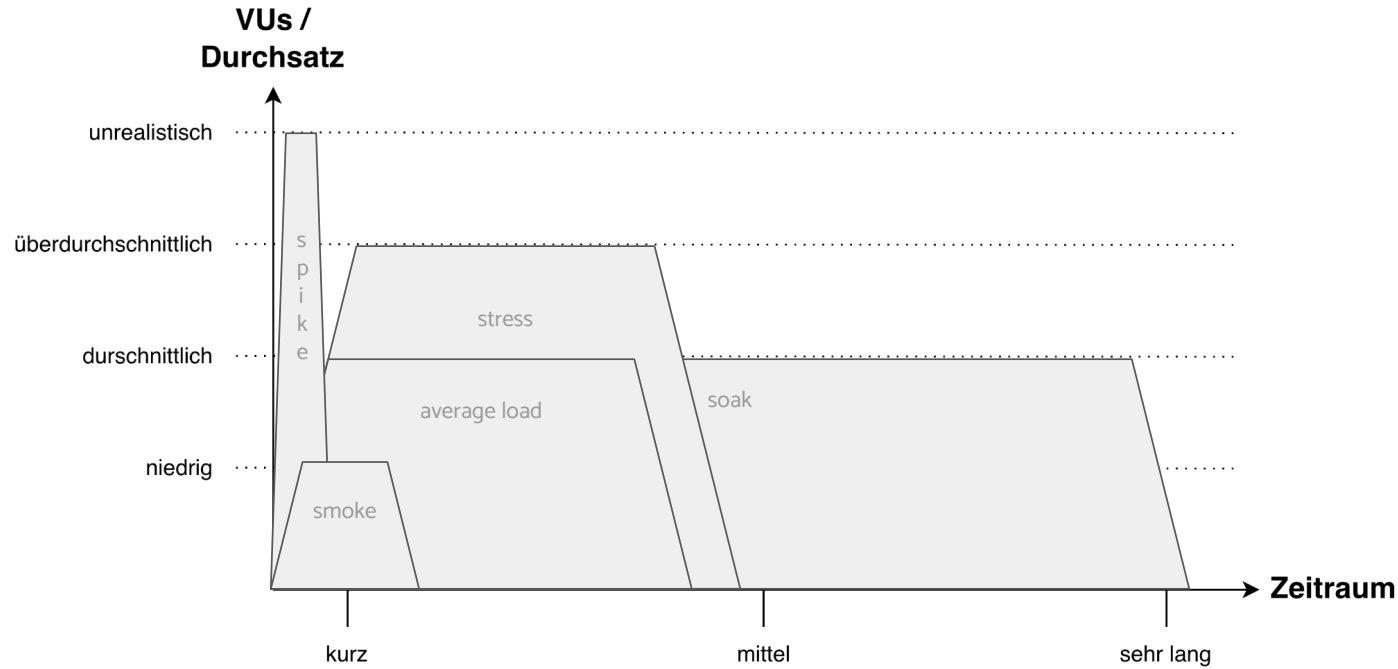


Labor Umgebung

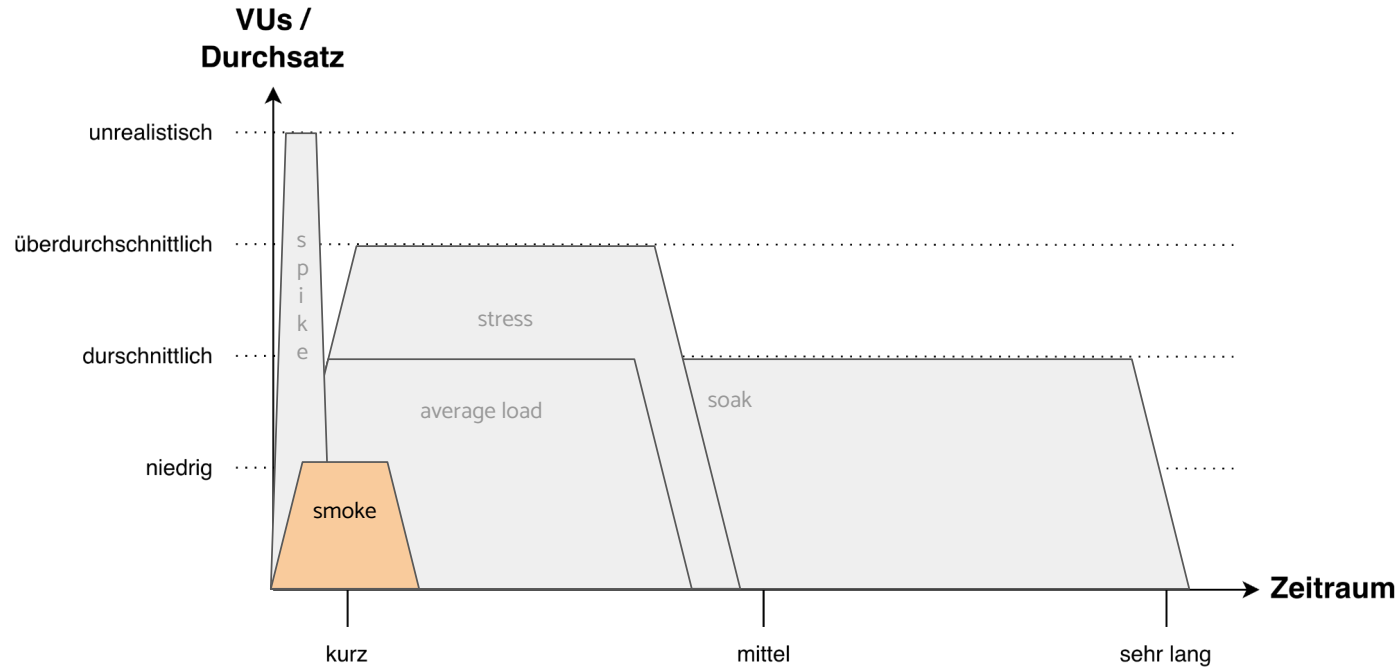
- z.B. **Single Pod** Perspektive
- Ermittlung der **Resource Usage**
- Experimentieren mit Werten für **requests** und **limits**
- Nur **notwendige Abhängigkeiten** werden mit getestet
- **Single node** cluster ohne autoscaling



Arten von Lasttests



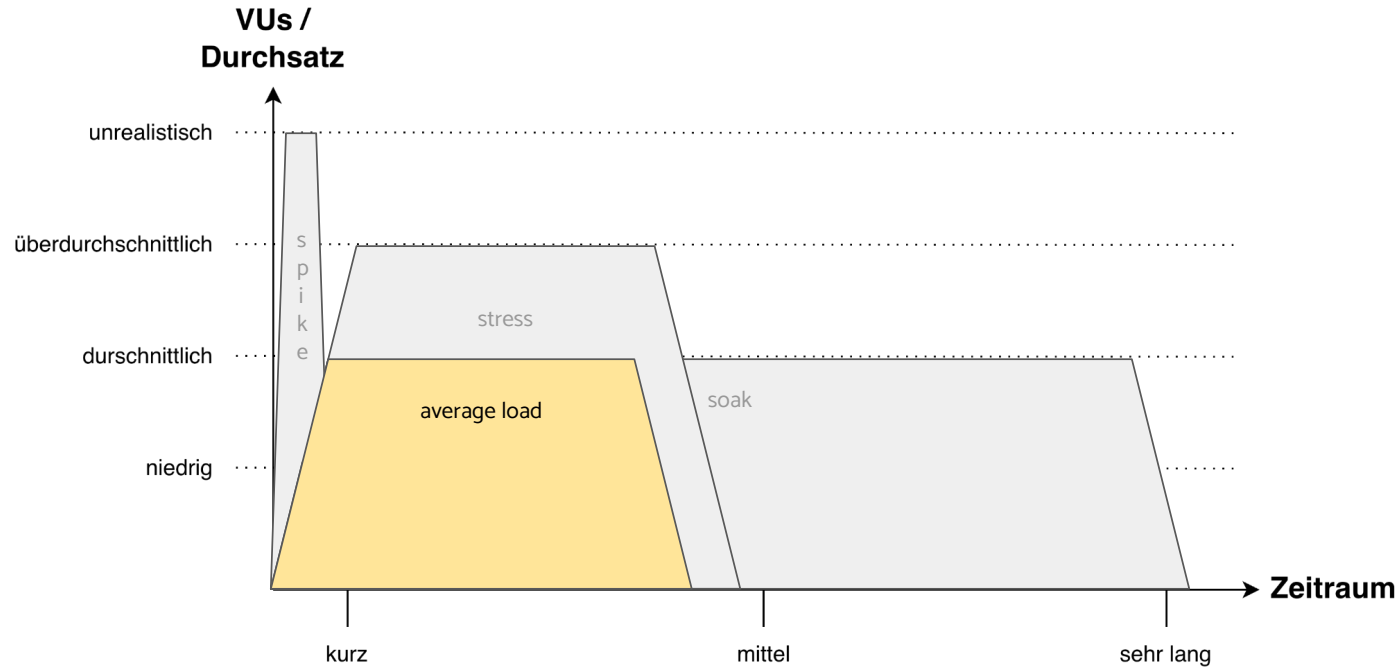
Smoke Test



Genereller Funktionstest

Z.B. zum Validieren eines
Test-Szenarios

Average Load Test



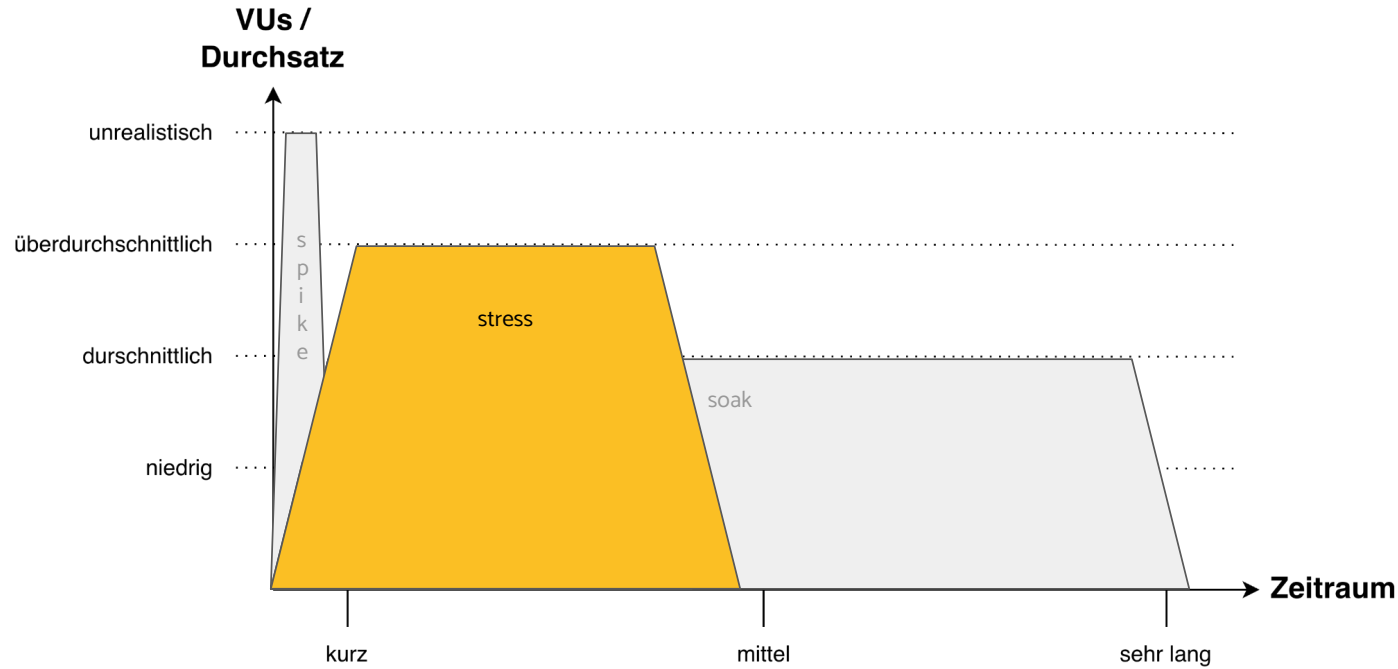
Alltagslast

Ermitteln der Baseline

- CPU Verbrauch
- RAM Verbrauch
- Antwortzeit

Stabiler Betrieb (SLA)

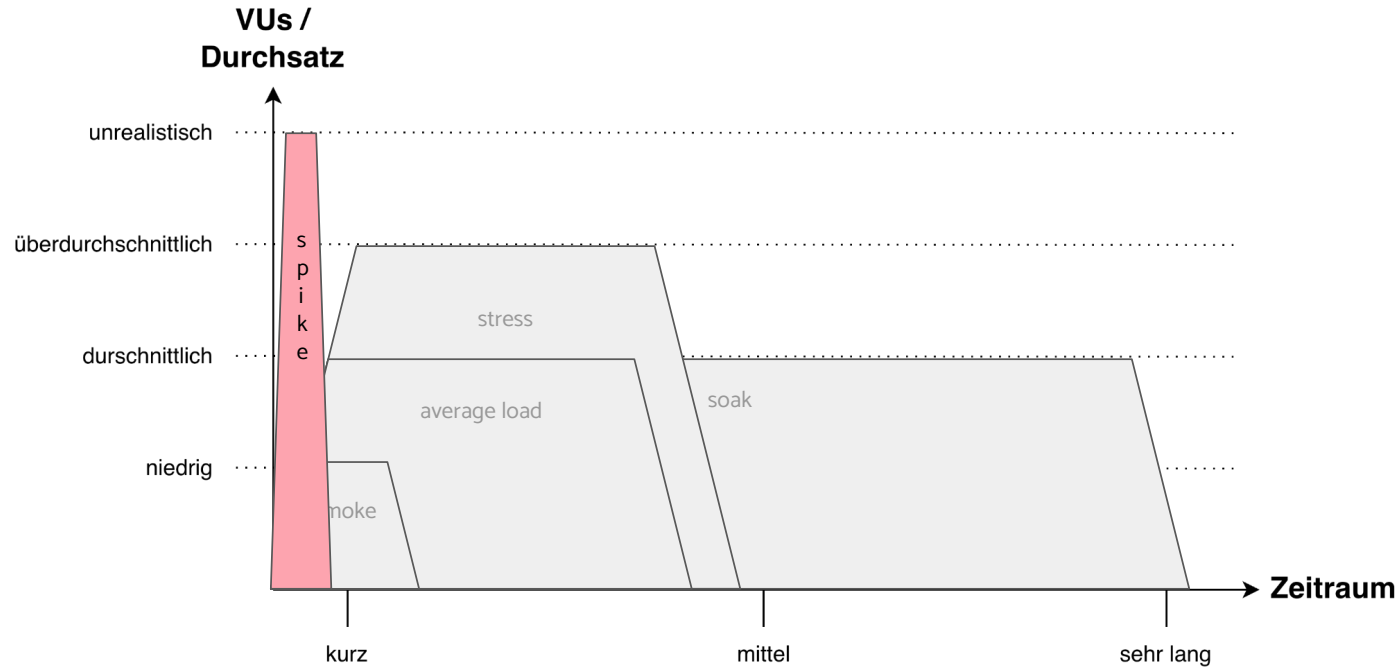
Stress Test



Black Friday Test (1/2)

Test des autoscalings
und der Resilienz

Spike Test



Black Friday Test (2/2)

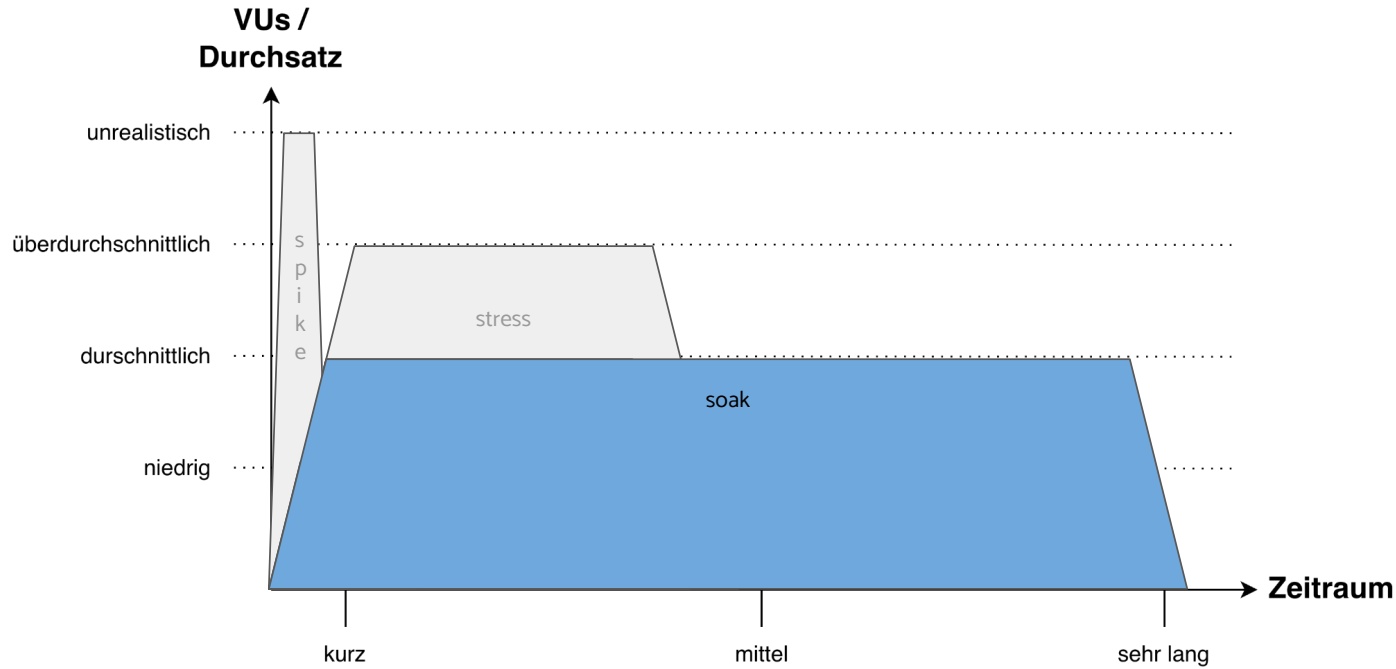
Scale up/down

- HPA
- Cluster autoscaler

Resilienz

- Ausfall?
- Wie lange? (MTTR)
- Blast Radius

Soak Test



Langzeittest (z.B. 24h)

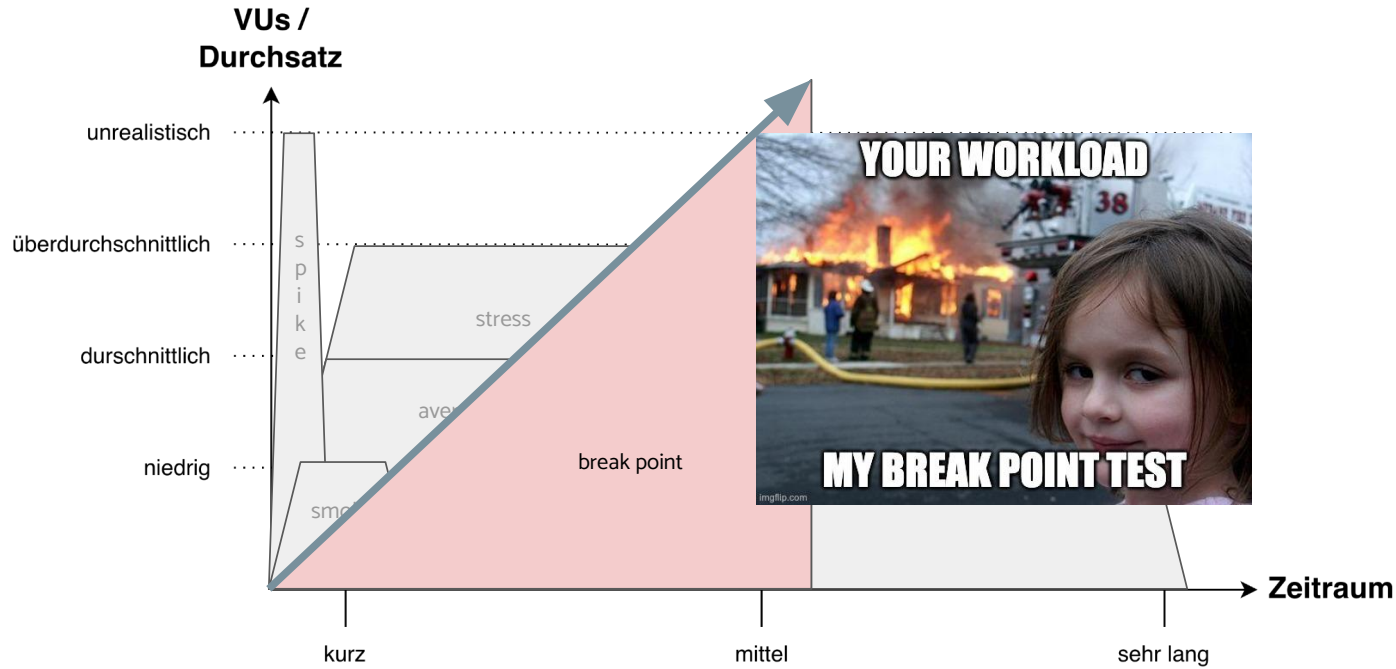
Ermitteln von Langzeit Effekten:

- Memory Leaks
- Connection Pool Exhaustion
- Performance Degradation
- Disks filling up (Logs / Database)

Verhalten während Maintenance Tasks:

- Upgrades
- Migrationen

Break Point Test



*Erhöhung bis zum
Kollaps*

Ermitteln von:

- max. Kapazität
- Bottlenecks

Was ist der richtige Test / die richtige Testumgebung für mich?



It depends...

Welche individuellen Fragen
sollen beantwortet werden?



Kombination

Selten kann ein einzelner Test
alle relevanten Fragen direkt
beantworten



Evolutionär

Im Laufe der Zeit werden sich
Ihre Fragen ändern.

Load Generatoren

Anforderungen:

- **Protokoll-Vielfalt:**
Support für HTTP/S, WebSockets, gRPC, MQTT, TCP, ...
- **As-Code & CI/CD-Integration:**
Definition von Tests als Code (JS, Java, Python) und einfache Einbindung in Pipelines.
- **Verteilte Last (Distributed Testing):**
Native Fähigkeit, Last über mehrere Worker-Nodes/Cluster hinweg zu skalieren.
- **Flexibles Test-Modeling:**
Präzise Steuerung von Virtual Users (VU) / Requests/s, Ramp-up/down und komplexen Szenarien. Nutzung von HAR Files
- **Metriken & Echtzeit-Reporting:**
Export/Streaming von Live-Daten (Prometheus, InfluxDB) und detaillierte HTML-/Konsolen-Berichte.
- **Erweiterbarkeit (Plugins):**
Nachladen von Drittanbieter-Bibliotheken oder Custom-Protokollen.

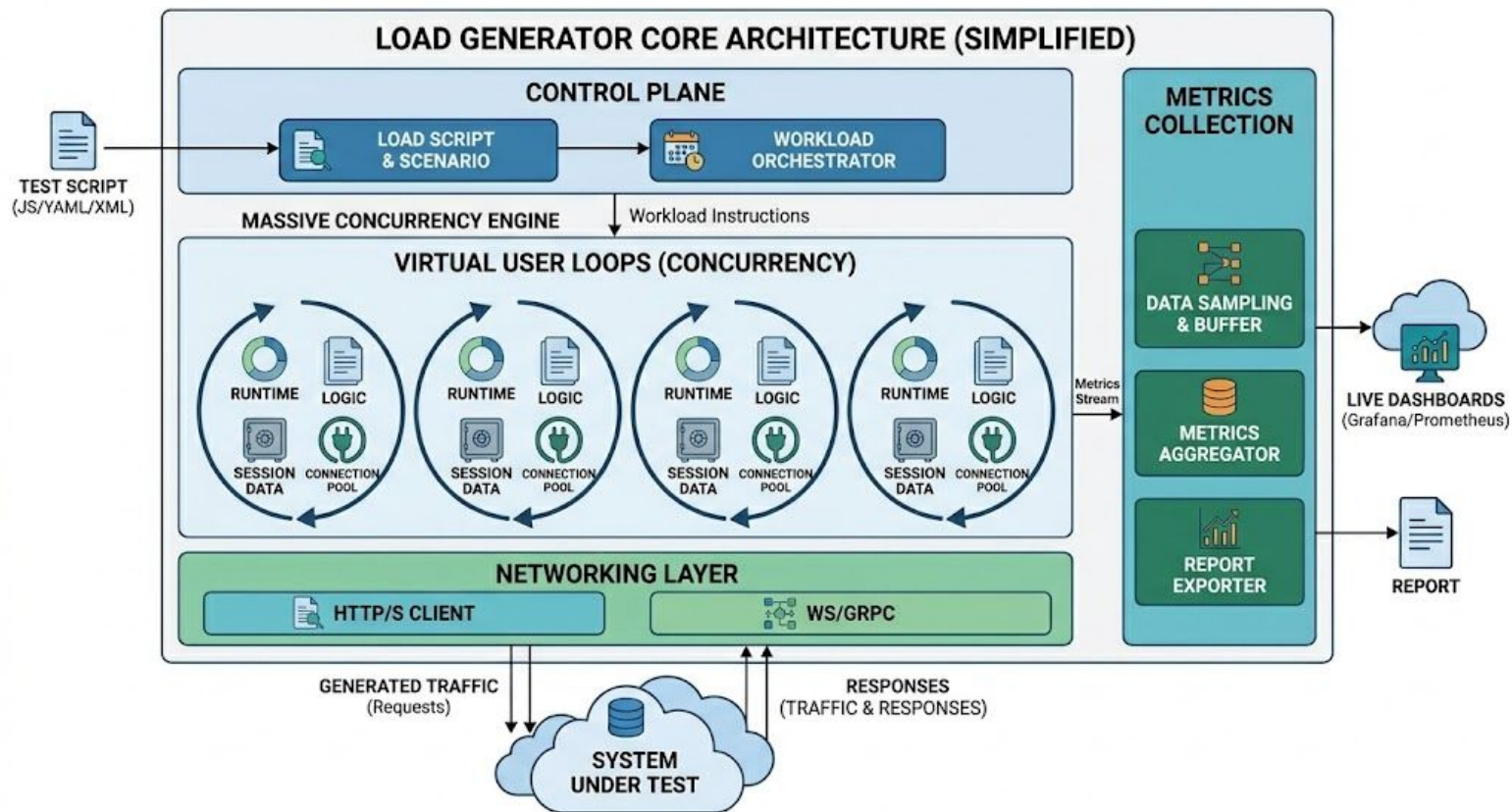
z.B.:

- k6
- Gatling
- Locust
- Artillery
- Apache jMeter

Testbeispiel

```
1  import { check, sleep } from "k6";
2  import http from "k6/http";
3
4  export let options = {
5    stages: [
6      { duration: "1m", target: 5 },    // ramp up
7      { duration: "3m", target: 10 },   // main
8      { duration: "1m", target: 0 },    // ramp down
9    ]
10 };
11
12 export default function() {
13   let res = http.get("https://iits-consulting.de");
14   check(res, {
15     "is status 200": (r) => r.status === 200
16   });
17   sleep(1);
18 };
```

Wie funktioniert ein Load Generator?



k6 run ./basic-load.js



execution: local

script: ./basic-load.js

output: -

scenarios: (100.00%) 1 scenario, 10 max VUs, 5m30s max duration (incl. graceful stop):

* default: Up to 10 looping VUs for 5m0s over 3 stages (gracefulRampDown: 30s, gracefulStop: 30s)

running (0m44.5s), 03/10 VUs, 73 complete and 0 interrupted iterations

default [====>-----] 03/10 VUs 0m44.5s/5m00.0s

TOTAL RESULTS

```
checks_total.....: 1543    5.127954/s
checks_succeeded...: 71.35% 1101 out of 1543
checks_failed.....: 28.64% 442 out of 1543
```

```
x is status 200
↳ 71% - ✓ 1101 / x 442
```

HTTP

```
http_req_duration.....: avg=130.43ms min=22.99ms  med=148.97ms max=1.27s p(90)=180.94ms p(95)=188.84ms
{ expected_response:true }...: avg=165.55ms min=120.53ms med=157.05ms max=1.27s p(90)=184.55ms p(95)=192.75ms
http_req_failed.....: 28.64% 442 out of 1543
http_reqs.....: 1543    5.127954/s
```

EXECUTION

```
iteration_duration.....: avg=1.13s    min=1.02s    med=1.15s    max=2.28s p(90)=1.18s    p(95)=1.19s
iterations.....: 1543    5.127954/s
vus.....: 1      min=1      max=10
vus_max.....: 10     min=10     max=10
```

NETWORK

```
data_received.....: 203 MB 675 kB/s
data_sent.....: 771 kB 2.6 kB/s
```

PERFORMANCE OVERVIEW



The 95th percentile response time of the system being tested was 477 ms, and 1 303 requests were made with 371 failures at an average rate of 4.2 requests/second.



REQUESTS MADE

1.3K reqs

HTTP FAILURES

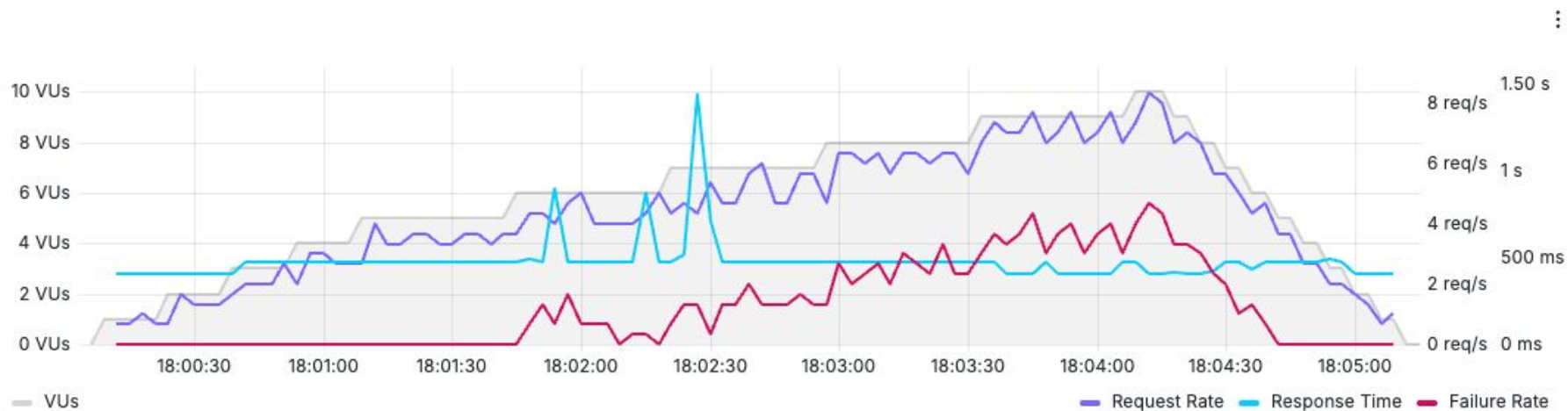
371 reqs

PEAK RPS

8.33 reqs/s

P95 RESPONSE TIME

477 ms



SCENARIOS (0)

SHOW



No scenario was configured in this test. [Check out how to create one](#)

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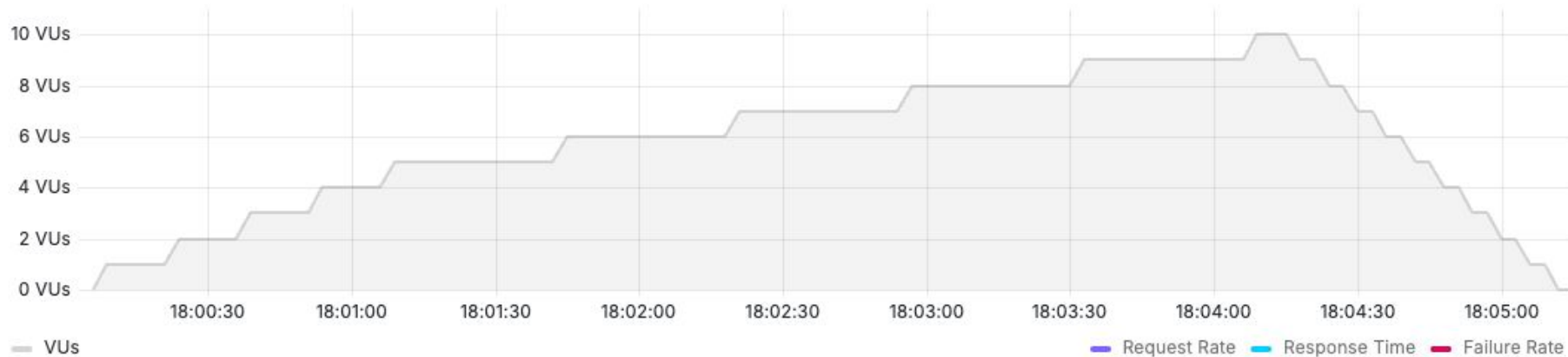
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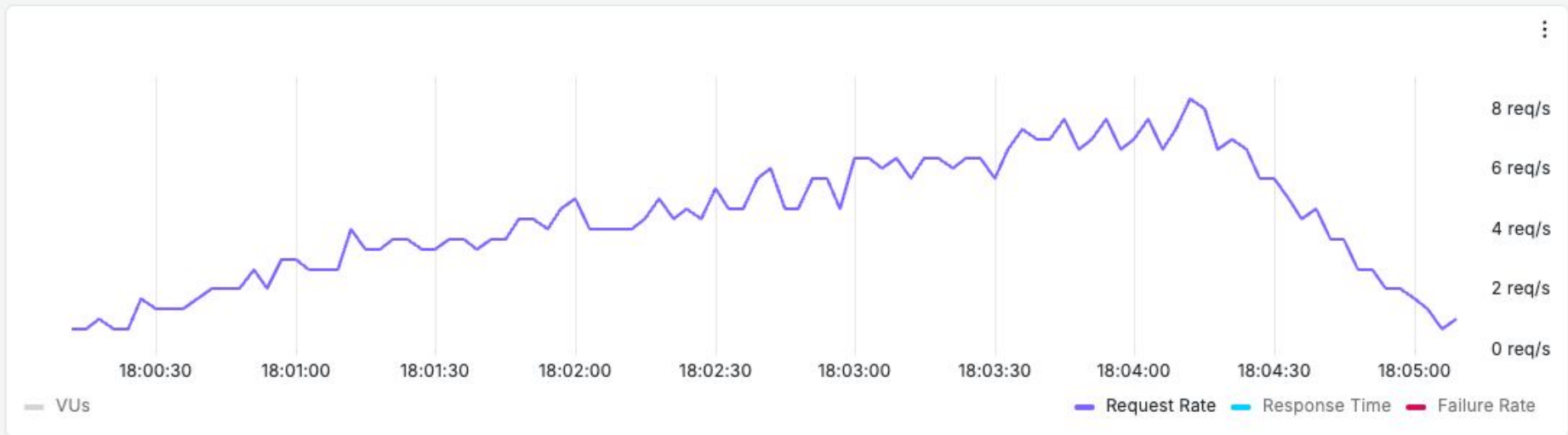
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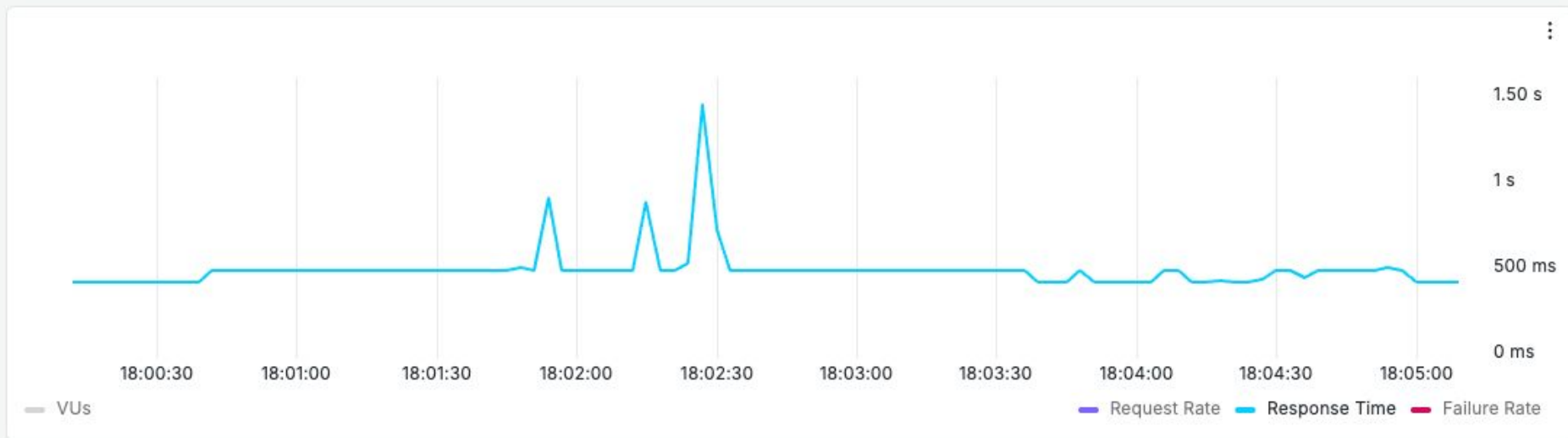
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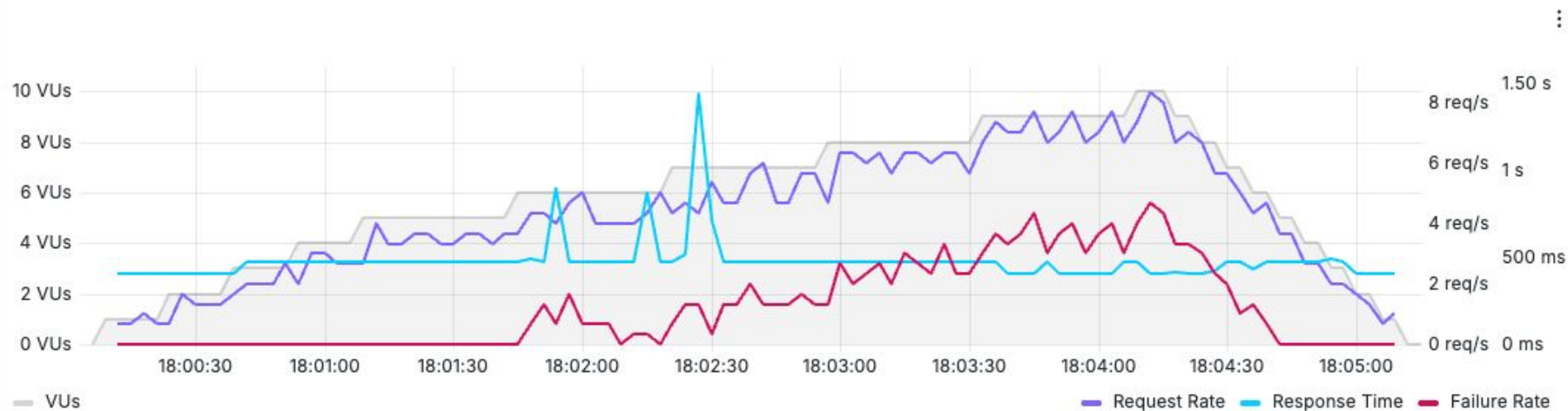
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Quick select ▾ Add filter ▾ List Tree										
⋮ URL >	SCENARIO >	METHOD >	STATUS >	COUNT >	MIN >	AVG >	STDDEV >	P95 >	P99 >	MAX >
✓ iits-consulting.de/	default	GET	200	932	404 ms	431 ms	92 ms	477 ms	493 ms	1 s
✗ iits-consulting.de/	default	GET	429	371	101 ms	113 ms	8.2 ms	119 ms	119 ms	119 ms

HTTP/1.1 429 Too Many Requests

Gelernte Lektionen (1/3)

Zugriff auf Observability Systeme notwendig:



Monitoring



Metriken



Traces



Logs



Gelernte Lektionen (2/3)



It's still hardware (somewhere)

Sometimes 2 Cores < 1 Core (Node types matter)



I/O Caching

Leave some free RAM on the node for I/O Caching



Self-Managed Kubernetes

If you manage Kubernetes yourself: Set kubeReserved and systemReserved before any testing

Gelernte Lektionen (3/3)



Kommunikation

Lasttest vorher mit relevanten Abteilungen und Dienstleistern abstimmen.



Fokus behalten

Nie mehr als eine Änderung gleichzeitig vornehmen.



Dokumentation

Jede Veränderung und das dazugehörige Ergebnis dokumentieren.



Reproduzierbarkeit

Tests wiederholen, um zufällige äußere Faktoren auszuschließen.



Root Cause Analysis

Wenn etwas bricht, die Ursache(n) finden, dokumentieren und dann reparieren



Realistische Erwartung

Dinge werden kaputt gehen – Das ist der Weg

The background of the slide is a dark, starry space. In the upper right corner, a blue and white planet (resembling Earth or the Moon) is visible. Below it, a black spaceship with a blue engine glow is flying towards the left. The main text is centered in the middle of the slide.

**Mögen die Lasttests
mit Ihnen sein...**



...und Ihnen Erkenntnisse bringen.



Vielen Dank



stephan.schwarz@iits-consulting.de